growth for two consecutive years is equivalent to approximately ₹2.31 lakh crore (₹2.31 trillion).[10]

Not surprisingly, government spokespersons sought to downplay the impact of demonetization on economic growth. As GDP growth for April–June 2017 dropped for the sixth quarter in a row to hit a three-year low of 5.7 per cent, BJP President Amit Shah, while addressing industrialists at a FICCI session in New Delhi on 9 September 2017, attributed this to 'technical reasons'. 'The Modi government has changed the way GDP is looked at, as it is not only limited to production, services, and infrastructure but also includes improving overall quality of life and social capital,' he said.

In a strong rebuttal to Amit Shah's statement, SBI research[11] reported on 19 September 2017:

> We certainly believe that we are in a slowdown mode since September 2016 and a slowdown that has been *prolonged* to Q1 of this fiscal year *is technically not short-term in nature or even transient*... While it is true that the economy has undergone too many structural breaks since November 2016 and that may have precipitated a transient slowdown, it will be unfair if we only call it transient. A slowdown in demand has only aggravated the situation.

Speaking in Davos in January 2018, former Governor of the RBI Raghuram G. Rajan said that a substantial part of the continuing growth slowdown in India was because of the after-effects of the demonetization decision of November 2016. 'I would suspect that a substantial part of the growth slowdown was because of the effects of demonetization... Some of it was in the informal economy, which weren't immediately captured, which we are seeing now. Businesses that have shut down, because they couldn't survive that episode,' Rajan said.

Only time will reveal the true long-term and residual impact of demonetization on India's GDP, provided, of course, that statistics that finally get officially released are comparable! For the present, what we can say is that even based on the most conservative estimates, the impact on India's GDP was definitely significant and negatively so.